IMovies

Phase-Wise Project Documentation

MERN-style Movie Ticket Booking College Project

Purpose: This document records the project structure, completed features, local testing, and remaining steps needed to publish a demo link for evaluation.

1. Project Overview

IMovies is a movie ticket booking web application. Users can register or log in, browse movies, select seats, confirm a booking, view booking history, and cancel a booking. The payment page is a demo flow only; it does not process real payments.

Project name	IMovies
Frontend	React + Vite
Backend	Node.js + Express
Database (local)	MongoDB
Source code repository	https://github.com/nandanig18/IMovies
Frontend local URL	http://localhost:5173/
Backend local URL	http://localhost:5000/

2. Phase-Wise Development

Phase 1 — Project Setup

Status: Completed

Created the IMovies project folder with separate frontend and backend folders.

Prepared the React/Vite frontend and Node.js backend.

Set up local development commands and ports.

Phase 2 — Backend and Database

Status: Completed locally

Connected the backend to a local MongoDB database named imovies.

Movies API works at http://localhost:5000/api/movies.

Bookings API responds at http://localhost:5000/api/bookings.

Local database works; an online database still needs to be configured for deployment.

Phase 3 — Authentication

Status: Completed and tested locally

Implemented registration and login.

JWT token is generated and stored in localStorage.

Phase 4 — Movie and Seat Booking

Status: Completed and tested locally

Displays sample movies: Inception, 3 Idiots, and Dangal.

Users can select a movie and seats.

Booking total is calculated at ₹150 per selected seat.

Phase 5 — Booking History and Cancellation

Status: Completed and tested locally

My Bookings page displays booking details.

Users can cancel a booking; cancelled bookings are removed from the list.

Phase 6 — Demo Payment Flow

Status: Completed and tested locally

Confirm Booking navigates to the demo payment page.

Pay Now displays a demo success result.

No real payment gateway or real-money transaction is connected.

Phase 7 — GitHub Version Control

Status: Completed

Initialized Git and committed the project.

Pushed frontend and backend code to the public GitHub repository.

Root .gitignore excludes .env files, node_modules, and dist.

The local backend/.env file should remain private and must not be uploaded.

Phase 8 — Online Deployment

Status: In progress / Not completed

Render account creation was started, but email verification is not yet confirmed.

Next: finish Render verification and deploy the backend as a Web Service.

Configure an online MongoDB database and set deployment environment variables securely.

Deploy the frontend on Vercel and set its API URL to the deployed backend.

Test the public website and booking flow.

3. Local Testing Checklist

Test	Result
Movies page loads	PASS
Seat selection works	PASS
Confirm Booking opens payment page	PASS

Demo payment success appears	PASS
My Bookings displays booking history	PASS
Cancel booking removes booking from list	PASS

4. Important Project Paths

Project root: C:\Users\WIN!0\Desktop\IMovies

Backend: C:\Users\WIN!0\Desktop\IMovies\backend

Frontend: C:\Users\WIN!0\Desktop\IMovies\frontend

5. How to Run the Project Locally

Open a terminal for the backend and run:

```
cd '/c/Users/WIN!0/Desktop/IMovies/backend'
node index.js
```

Open a second terminal for the frontend and run:

```
cd '/c/Users/WIN!0/Desktop/IMovies/frontend'
npm run dev
```

Then open http://localhost:5173/ in the browser.

6. Deployment Plan — Remaining Work

1. Complete Render email verification.
2. Create/configure an online MongoDB database (for example, MongoDB Atlas) and copy its connection URI privately.
3. Deploy the backend on Render; configure MONGO_URI and JWT_SECRET in Render Environment settings. Never put secret values in the source code or share them in screenshots.
4. Deploy the frontend on Vercel and configure the frontend API base URL to point to the Render backend.
5. Test registration, login, movie listing, booking, booking history, and cancellation using the public URL.
6. Save the final Vercel demo URL for the teacher. The app is not publicly live yet.

7. Security and Scope Notes

Do not upload backend/.env or expose MongoDB credentials/JWT secrets.

The current payment screen is only a demo and should be described honestly during evaluation.

A public GitHub repository is not the same as a deployed live website.

Deployment may require small configuration changes depending on the hosting platform.

8. Current Overall Status

Core project: Implemented and tested locally.
Source code: Uploaded to GitHub.
Public demo link: Pending deployment.